



CSCI 232

232 Algorithms & Data Structures

LECTURE: 4

J. L. Pach

| OUTLINE:

- 🔧 GitHub basics
- 🔧 Fork
- 🔧 Core Workflow

GITHUB

WHAT IS GITHUB?

- ⌘ A **cloud-based platform** for hosting Git repositories.
- ⌘ Provides **collaboration tools**: pull requests, issues, code review.
- ⌘ Integrates with **Continuous Integration (CI) / Continuous Delivery (CD)**, project management, and documentation.
- ⌘ Owned by **Microsoft** since 2018.

GIT VS GITHUB

- ⌘ **Git** = version control system (local).
- ⌘ **GitHub** = remote hosting + collaboration features.
- ⌘ GitHub uses Git under the hood.

GITHUB AUTHENTICATION METHODS

✂ HTTPS:

- ✂ Login with **username + password** (deprecated for push).
- ✂ Now requires **Personal Access Token (PAT)** instead of password.

✂ SSH:

- ✂ Secure authentication using **SSH keys**.
- ✂ Recommended for frequent use.

✂ GitHub CLI (gh)

AUTHENTICATION — HTTPS ONLY

- ✕ In this course we use **HTTPS only**
- ✕ Every `push` requires:
 - ✕ **username** — your GitHub login
 - ✕ **password** — a **Personal Access Token (PAT)**, not your account password
- ✕ No SSH setup required on lab machines.

SSH — IT EXISTS, BUT NOT NOW

- ✂ GitHub also supports **SSH key** authentication
- ✂ More secure and convenient for frequent use
- ✂ For this course — **we are not setting up SSH**, HTTPS is sufficient

HOW TO CREATE A NEW REPOSITORY ON GITHUB 1/2

1. **Log in** to your GitHub account.
2. Click the **"+" icon** in the top-right corner.
3. Select **"New repository"**.
4. Enter a **Repository name** (e.g., my-project).
5. (Optional) Add a **Description**.
6. Choose **Public** or **Private** visibility.

HOW TO CREATE A NEW REPOSITORY ON GITHUB 2/2

7. (Optional) Initialize with:

✚ README.md

✚ .gitignore

✚ License

8. Click **Create repository**.

9. Copy the **SSH or HTTPS URL** to clone locally.

FROM MASTER TO MAIN – WHY THE CHANGE? 1/2

Background:

- ✂ Historically, Git's default branch was named **master**.
- ✂ In recent years, the term was considered **politically and socially insensitive** in some contexts.

GitHub's Response:

- ✂ GitHub changed the **default branch name** to **main** for new repositories.
- ✂ This is part of an **inclusive language initiative** across the tech industry.

FROM MASTER TO MAIN – WHY THE CHANGE? 2/2

What Does This Mean for You?

- ✚ When creating new repositories on GitHub, the default branch will be **main**.
- ✚ If your local repo still uses **master**, you can rename it:

```
git branch -m master main
```

HTTPS VS SSH — DO NOT MIX UP THE LINKS!

Every repository has **two different URLs**:

HTTPS: `https://github.com/user/repo.git`

SSH: `git@github.com:user/repo.git`

If you configured HTTPS — use the HTTPS link.

If you configured SSH — use the SSH link.

Mixing these links = authentication error.

Most common mistake at the start — remember it now.

GIT

clone

GIT CLONE — WHAT DOES IT ACTUALLY DO?

```
git clone https://github.com/YOUR-LOGIN/repo.git
```

- ✖ Downloads the entire repository from the remote server **to your disk**
- ✖ Creates a folder named after the repository
- ✖ Automatically sets up `origin` — remembers where you cloned from
- ✖ After clone you have the **full commit history** locally

THE CORE WORKFLOW

```
git clone https://github.com/YOUR-LOGIN/repo.git # 1. Clone your fork (once only)
```

```
cd repo # 2. Enter the folder
```

```
# 3. Modify the code in your editor
```

```
git status # 4. Check what changed
```

```
git add . # 5. Add files to the staging area
```

```
git commit -m "implement bubble sort" # 6. Commit with a description
```

```
git push # 7. Send to GitHub
```

STAGING AREA — WHY THIS EXTRA STEP?

[files on disk] → git add → [staging area] → git commit → [history]

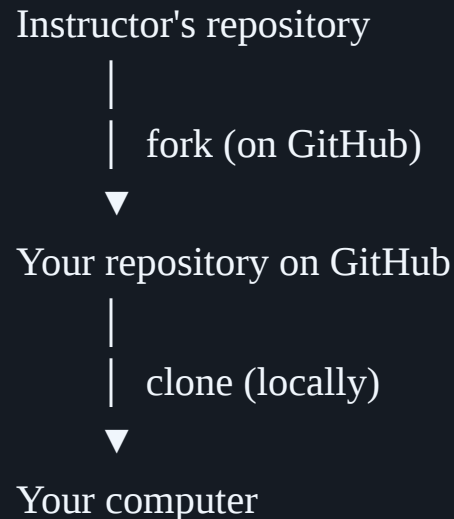
- ⌘ `git add` — tell Git: **include these files in the next commit**
- ⌘ `git commit` — **save a snapshot** of the staging area into history
- ⌘ Lets you modify many files but commit **selectively**

```
git add sort.c    # single file
git add .         # all modified files
git status        # always check before committing
```

FORK

WHAT IS A FORK?

- ✂ **Fork** = your own copy of someone else's repository on `GitHub`
- ✂ Changes in your fork **do not affect** the original repository
- ✂ In this course: each assignment comes as a repository link
- ✂ You **fork** → **clone** → **work locally** → **push to your fork**



HOW TO FORK A REPOSITORY

1. Go to the assignment repository page
2. Click the **Fork** button (top-right corner)
3. Select your account as the destination
4. GitHub creates a copy under your account
5. Copy the **HTTPS link** to your fork

You clone **your fork**, not the instructor's repository.

THE FULL PICTURE

[Your fork on GitHub]



| git push



[Your computer — local repo]



| git add + git commit



[Files in folder — working directory]



clone — once, at the beginning



add → commit → push — after every meaningful change

COMMON MISTAKES

Mistake	Cause
<code>Permission denied</code> on push	Used SSH link with HTTPS configuration
<code>remote: Invalid username or password</code>	PAT expired or typed account password
<code>nothing to commit</code>	Forgot <code>git add</code> before <code>git commit</code>
Push works but CI sees no changes	Cloned instructor's repo instead of your fork

SUMMARY

1. **Fork** the assignment repository on GitHub
2. **Clone** your fork locally
3. Work locally: **modify** → **add** → **commit**
4. **Push** to your fork
5. CI checks your code automatically

One cycle: `git add .` → `git commit -m "..."` → `git push`

Master this — you will do it every single class.

THANK

You!